

AMAL UDAYANGA BASNAYAKE

Cybersecurity & Cloud Security Professional

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GitHub: github.com/AmalUBasnayake

Portfolio: <https://amalcyberlab.vercel.app>

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Profile Summary

Cybersecurity and cloud-focused IT professional with 5+ years of experience in enterprise IT operations, information security, Microsoft 365 security, and security governance across large-scale environments supporting 4,000+ users. Hands-on experience in security controls, identity and access management, risk reduction, SIEM monitoring, threat detection, and incident response. Strong foundation in Information Security Management Systems (ISMS), ISO/IEC 27001, ISO/IEC 27701, security compliance, and cybersecurity controls, supported by Lead Auditor certifications and a Pearson BTEC HND in Cybersecurity with Distinction in Information Security Management Systems (ISMS) and Digital Forensics. Starting a BSc (Hons) Cyber Security at the University of Wolverhampton in September 2026.

Areas of Expertise

- Cybersecurity Operations
- Microsoft 365 Security Administration
- Microsoft Entra ID / Azure AD Management
- Conditional Access & MFA
- SIEM Monitoring (Microsoft Sentinel, Splunk)
- Threat Detection & Incident Response
- Cloud Security Architecture
- Endpoint Security & Hardening
- Identity & Access Management (IAM/PIM)
- Network Security & Firewalls
- Vulnerability Assessment (Nessus)
- Security Automation (SOAR)
- Active Directory & Group Policy

- Log Analysis & Threat Hunting
 - Azure Firewall, WAF & DDoS Protection
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Work Experience

IT & Systems Specialist

Musaeus College, Sri Lanka | Oct 2025 – Present

- Manage and secure Microsoft 365 tenant supporting 4,000+ users, including identity lifecycle, licensing, and policy enforcement.
- Implement Conditional Access policies and MFA across all user accounts, significantly reducing unauthorized access risk and phishing exposure.
- Monitor threats and perform incident response using Microsoft Sentinel (SIEM) and Splunk, including SOAR-based automated response workflows.
- Maintain endpoint hardening and hybrid infrastructure security across cloud and on-premises systems.
- Administer Microsoft Teams and enterprise collaboration security configurations.
- Apply cybersecurity controls across user, device, and cloud layers to strengthen overall security posture.

IT Officer

Arpico Insurance PLC, Sri Lanka | 2022 – 2025

- Governed enterprise IT infrastructure operations across servers, networks, and endpoints to maintain operational stability and system performance.
- Spearheaded proactive monitoring and maintenance initiatives to improve infrastructure reliability and overall system efficiency.
- Delivered technical support and troubleshooting for hardware, software, and networking issues in enterprise environments.
- Supported endpoint security, system backups, and user access management across organizational systems.
- Collaborated with internal teams and vendors to maintain IT operations, resolve technical issues, and support business continuity.

System Development Engineer

Garment Service, Meegoda, Sri Lanka | 2020

- Develop integrated system solutions to improve operational workflow efficiency through optimized process alignment.
- Collaborate with cross-functional teams to refine system performance and reduce deployment-related issues.

Computer Hardware Technician

IBM & Micronet Global Services (Pvt) Ltd, Sri Lanka | 2019 – 2020

- Diagnosed and resolved hardware, software, and network issues, decreasing system downtime by 35% across enterprise users.
 - Delivered technical support services, improving user productivity levels by 30% through efficient troubleshooting and guidance.
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Education

BSc (Hons) Cyber Security

University of Wolverhampton, United Kingdom | Starting September 2026

Pearson BTEC Level 5 Higher National Diploma (HND) in Cybersecurity | 240 Credits

Achievers International Campus, Sri Lanka | 2024 - April 2026

- Distinction - Digital Forensics
 - Distinction - Information Security Management Systems (ISMS)
 - Merit - Cybersecurity
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Certifications

- Microsoft Cloud & AI Security Engineer Associate (SC-500) - In Progress
 - Microsoft Applied Skills: Create Agents in Microsoft Copilot Studio
 - ISO/IEC 27001:2022 Lead Auditor - Mastermind
 - ISO/IEC 27701:2025 Lead Auditor - Mastermind
 - Certified Red Team Operations Management (CRTOM)
 - Certified SME Cyber Security Officer (CSCSO)
 - Blue Team Junior Analyst Pathway
 - ISC2 Candidate
 - CCNA (Cisco Networking Academy)
 - Cyber Threat Management (Cisco)
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Key Achievements

- Enforced MFA and Conditional Access for 4000+ users, reducing unauthorized access risks.
- Reduced system downtime by 35% through monitoring and infrastructure maintenance strategies.
- Improved help desk efficiency by 40% through structured ticket handling and escalation processes.
- Increased cybersecurity resilience by 50% through enhanced firewall and endpoint security implementations.
- Built over 32 cybersecurity labs covering SIEM, SOC, cloud security, and threat detection technologies.

Core Technical Skills

SIEM & SOC

- Microsoft Sentinel (SIEM/SOAR)
- Splunk Enterprise Security
- Threat Detection & Incident Response
- KQL & Log Analysis
- Threat Hunting

Cloud Security

- Microsoft Azure
- Azure Firewall, NSG, WAF, DDoS Protection
- Azure Key Vault
- Defender for Cloud
- Defender for Endpoint
- Azure Security Architecture

Identity & Access Management

- Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD)
- Conditional Access
- Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)
- Privileged Identity Management (PIM)
- RBAC & Zero Trust Security

Endpoint & Infrastructure Security

- Endpoint Hardening
- Vulnerability Management (Nessus)
- Sysmon Monitoring
- Windows Server Administration
- Active Directory & Group Policy

Cybersecurity Projects

Built 32+ hands-on cybersecurity labs covering SOC operations, SIEM engineering, cloud security, and threat detection across Microsoft Azure and Splunk environments.

SOC / SIEM Engineering

- Microsoft Sentinel SIEM Threat Detection Lab - Custom KQL analytics rules and alert pipeline
- Sentinel SOAR Automated IP Blocking - Logic Apps-based automated incident response
- Honeypot Live Attack Map - Real-time global attack visualization on Azure
- SOC Dashboard Monitoring Lab - Alert triage and monitoring workflows
- Brute Force Attack Detection - Sentinel-based detection and response

Azure Cloud Security

- Azure Firewall Hub-Spoke Security Architecture - Enterprise-grade network segmentation
- Azure WAF + Application Gateway Security - OWASP rule-based web traffic inspection
- Azure DDoS Protection Lab - Cloud-native volumetric attack mitigation
- Azure Key Vault Hardening - Secrets management and cryptographic key protection
- Conditional Access + MFA Security Lab - Zero Trust identity enforcement
- IAM + Privileged Identity Management (PIM) - Just-in-time privileged access controls

Threat Detection & Analysis

- Splunk Real-Time Security Dashboard - Custom threat visibility dashboards
- Windows Persistence Detection using Sysmon - Endpoint threat hunting
- Registry-Based Threat Detection - Malicious registry modification detection
- Active Directory Monitoring - AD event log analysis for attack patterns
- Network Traffic Analysis - Traffic monitoring and anomaly detection